

[NT Lesson 36](#): “Beloved of God, Called to Be Saints” Romans 2-6; 8; 12-13; 15:1-7 (See L36 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To remind us that we are children of God and to encourage us to live worthy of our divine inheritance.
[Ponderize Ether 12:27.](#)

1. We are justified by faith in Jesus Christ.

- Read and discuss [Romans 2-5](#). †1. Introduction
- Romans 2:13. “(For not the hearers of the law are just before God, **but the doers of the law shall be justified.**”
- Romans 2:25-29. “For circumcision verily profiteth, if thou keep the law: but [not] if thou be a breaker of the law ...”
- Romans 3:10-12, 23-26, 28, 31. “**As it is written, There is none righteous, no, not one: ... For all have sinned ...**”
- Romans 5:1-2. “**Therefore being justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ**”.

What does it mean to be justified? †2. Justified

What is grace? †3. [Grace](#) †4. President Dieter F. Uchtdorf

Why can't we earn justification and salvation exclusively through our works? (See [Mosiah 2:20-21](#).)

“Many people have interpreted Paul’s writings to mean that we can be justified through faith alone without good works.” (*Lesson Manual*)

What is the relationship between our actions (or works) and justification through the grace of Christ?

(See [Romans 3:31](#); [James 2:14-18, 24](#); [2 Nephi 25:23](#).) †5. The Prophet Joseph Smith

2. We can be reborn and become joint-heirs with Christ.

- Read [Romans 6](#) and [Romans 8](#).
 - Romans 6:1-2. “**Shall we continue in sin, that grace may abound? God forbid.**”
 - Romans 6:3-4. We who “were baptized unto Jesus Christ were baptized unto his death?”
- “Baptism by immersion is a symbol of our spiritual rebirth. When we go under the water, it is a symbol that we are burying our old self in a grave. When we come out of the water, we are symbolically washed clean. We have become a new person who has covenanted to follow Christ.” (*Lesson Manual*)
- How can we maintain the cleanness and “newness of life” we experienced at baptism?
- Romans 8:5-8, 13. “**For they that are after the flesh do mind the things of the flesh ...**”
- What does it mean to be “carnally minded”? †6. Definition: Carnal
- How can we eliminate the carnal from our minds and hearts?
- Romans 8:14-17. “**For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons ... the children of God.**”
- How have you been blessed when you have chosen to be spiritually minded? †7. Elder Dallin H. Oaks
- What does it mean to be a joint-heir with Christ? (See [D&C 76:50, 54-70](#).)
- What must we do to receive this great inheritance? (See [D&C 76:51-53](#).)
- Romans 8:18, 28, 31. “The sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared to the glory” to come.
 - Romans 8:28, 31. “**All things work together for good to them that love God ... If God be for us, who can be against us?**”
 - Romans 8:35-39. “**Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? ...**”
- How have you felt the Savior’s love in your life? What difference has it made? (See “[I Feel My Savior’s Love](#)”)

3. We should live as becomes Saints.

- Read selected verses from [Romans 12-13](#); [15:1-7](#).
 - Romans 12:1. “I beseech you ... that ye present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable unto God”.
- How can we present ourselves as living sacrifices to God? (See [3 Nephi 9:20](#); [D&C 59:8](#).)
- †8. Elder Bruce R. McConkie
- Romans 12:2. “And be not conformed to this world: **but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind**”.
- What are some attributes of true Saints Paul lists in Romans 12 and 13? Why is this attribute important?
- What can we do this week to develop this attribute?
- Romans 12:19-21. “If thine enemy hunger, feed him ... Be not overcome of evil, but overcome evil with good.”
 - Romans 13:8-10, 12-14. “**love one another: for he that loveth another hath fulfilled the law.**”
 - Romans 15:1-7. “We then that are strong ought to bear the infirmities of the weak, and not to please ourselves.”
- How can a person who is strong in the faith help a person who is weak?

Next Week: L37 “Jesus Christ: ‘The Author and Finisher of Our Faith’”; See L37: [Class Member Study Guide](#).
Read the Institute New Testament Student Manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

NT36 Quotes

†1. **Introduction:** “Paul had been writing to Church members in several areas who had returned to practicing the law of Moses, believing that strict observance of this law was necessary for salvation. Although the Saints in Rome were strong in the gospel (Romans 1:8), Paul wrote this epistle to emphasize that justification and salvation come through faith in Christ, not through the works of the law of Moses.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†2. **Justified:** “To be reconciled to God, pardoned from punishment for sin, and declared righteous and guiltless.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†3. **Grace:** “A word that occurs frequently in the New Testament, especially in the writings of Paul. The main idea of the word is divine means of help or strength, given through the bounteous mercy and love of Jesus Christ.” (Bible Dictionary, “[Grace](#),” 697.)

†4. **President Dieter F. Uchtdorf:** “However, I wonder if sometimes we misinterpret the phrase ‘after all we can do.’ We must understand that ‘after’ does not equal ‘because.’

“We are not saved ‘because’ of all that we can do. Have any of us done *all* that we can do? Does God wait until we’ve expended every effort before He will intervene in our lives with His saving grace?”

“Many people feel discouraged because they constantly fall short. They know firsthand that ‘the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak’ (Matt. 26:41; Romans 7:19). They raise their voices with Nephi in proclaiming, ‘My soul grieveth because of mine iniquities’ (2 Ne. 4:17).

“I am certain Nephi knew that the Savior’s grace *allows* and *enables* us to overcome sin (2 Nephi 4:19-35; Alma 34:31).

“After all, *that is* what we can do! And *that is* our task in mortality!” (“[The Gift of Grace](#),” *Ensign*, May 2015)

(For an example of grace, read [NT36 Enrichment.pdf](#): †1. **Prodigal Young Woman at a ‘Dude Ranch’ near Jackson Hole, Wyoming:** “Many years ago a young lady shared this experience with me. She is a remarkable disciple, and her life has come to typify the highest levels of Christian conduct and goodness, but for a time in junior high and high school, she strayed from the straight and narrow path and became lost like the prodigal son.

†5. **The Prophet Joseph Smith:** “To be justified before God we must love one another: we must overcome evil; we must visit the fatherless and the widow in their affliction, and we must keep ourselves unspotted from the world: for such virtues flow from the great fountain of pure religion, strengthening our faith by adding every good quality that adorns the children of the blessed Jesus. We can pray in the season of prayer; we can love our neighbor as ourselves, and be faithful in tribulation, knowing that the reward of such is greater in the kingdom of heaven.” (*TPJs*, sel. Joseph Fielding Smith [1976], 76).

†6. **Definition, Carnal:** “Carnal [ME ... fleshly *carnalis*, (in contrast to *spiritalis*, **SPIRITUAL** ...] 1. In or of the flesh; bodily; material or worldly, **not spiritual** ... [NEW WORLD DICTIONARY, David B. Guralnik] (p. 216).

†7. **Elder Dallin H. Oaks:** “Consider the power of the idea taught in our beloved song ‘I Am a Child of God’ (Hymns, 301). ... Here is the answer to one of life’s great questions, ‘Who am I?’ I am a child of God with a spirit lineage to heavenly parents. That parentage defines our eternal potential. That powerful idea is a potent antidepressant. It can strengthen each of us to make righteous choices and to seek the best that is within us. Establish in the mind of a young person the powerful idea that he or she is a child of God, and you have given self-respect and motivation to move against the problems of life” (“[Powerful Ideas](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1995, 25).

†8. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie:** “To present [oneself] as a living sacrifice is to come forth with a broken heart and a contrite spirit through obedience” (*Doctrinal New Testament Commentary*, 3 vols. [1966-73], 2:292).

Recommended Reading:

1. [NT36 Enrichment.pdf](#) contains more quotes and links to articles, blogs, and talks.
2. President Dieter F. Uchtdorf, “[The Gift of Grace](#),” *Ensign*, May 2015.
3. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 35: Romans 1-3](#).
4. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 36: Romans 4-8](#).
5. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 37: Romans 9-16](#)

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